

# CITS4401

## Software Requirements & Design

### Group Project Phase 1

#### Group 39

|                        |          |                      |
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## **1. Interview Questions and Justifications**

*Stakeholder: Administrative Staff*

### **1.1 When you check an application, what do you look for to decide whether it is complete? Does this differ depending on the type of research? What exactly happens if an application is deemed incomplete? Do you return it entirely to the researcher, or is it put 'on hold' while you request the missing documents?**

- **Uncertainty:**

- It is currently unclear what the exact criteria for “completeness” are and whether these criteria are standardised across all application types or vary depending on the research being conducted.

- **Ambiguity:**

- Interpretation A: All applications follow a single fixed checklist regardless of research type.
- Interpretation B: Different types of research (e.g., involving human participants, sensitive data, or minimal risk) require different documentation and completeness standards.

- **Expected Impact:**

- Determines whether the system needs a single or dynamic completeness checklist.
- Informs whether automated validation logic must be conditional based on research type.
- Affects the design of document upload requirements and form field rules within the system.

### **1.2 How do you currently track the status of applications, and what problems do you encounter in this process?**

- **Uncertainty:**

- The scenario mentions that administrative staff use spreadsheets, but provides no detail on what statuses are recorded, how granular the tracking is, or how updates are communicated across staff members.

- **Expected Impact:**

- Helps define the required set of application status types in the system (e.g., submitted, under review, awaiting clarification, approved).
- Determines whether real-time status visibility is needed for administrative staff.
- Informs the design of the application dashboard and workflow management features.

### **1.3 When an application has issues or needs revision, how do you communicate this to the researcher? Who is responsible for initiating that communication?**

- **Uncertainty:**

- The scenario does not specify whether clarification requests come from individual committee members or are consolidated and sent by administrative staff or the Committee Chair. The current communication channel is also unclear.
- **Ambiguity:**
  - Interpretation A: Individual committee members send clarification requests directly to the researcher, potentially resulting in multiple fragmented messages.
  - Interpretation B: All clarification requests are consolidated by administrative staff or the Committee Chair and sent as a single unified communication.
- **Expected Impact:**
  - Directly determines the communication architecture of the system.
  - Affects whether the system needs to support direct reviewer-to-researcher messaging or only admin-mediated requests.
  - Informs requirements for structured feedback features and revision request workflows.

#### **1.4 How are applications currently assigned to committee members? Do administrators manually select reviewers based on their expertise and workload, or are there strict university rules (e.g., based on risk level) that dictate exactly who must review it?**

- **Uncertainty:**
  - We know applications are assigned to one or more members, but we do not know the business rules governing this assignment or how the system should assist the administrator.
- **Ambiguity:**
  - Interpretation A: The administrator manually selects names from a digital list (requiring simple dropdown UI).
  - Interpretation B: The system should automatically suggest reviewers based on predefined risk logic and tracked workloads.
- **Expected Impact:**
  - This will dictate the complexity of the routing logic and whether the system needs to maintain "Reviewer Profiles" (expertise/workload tracking).

#### **1.5 What kinds of reminders or notifications would be most helpful for you in managing your workload?**

- **Assumption:**
  - We assume that automated notifications would improve administrative efficiency and reduce manual follow-up. However, the specific events that should trigger notifications, the recipients involved, and the preferred level of detail are currently unknown.
- **Expected Impact:**
  - Helps identify the required notification types and the events that should trigger them (e.g., new submission received, reviewer assigned, clarification sent, decision recorded).
  - Determines whether the system should support user-configurable notification preferences.

- Informs non-functional requirements around system responsiveness and proactive communication.

## **1.6 In your view, what information should different roles (e.g., researchers, administrators, committee members) be permitted to access?**

### ● **Uncertainty:**

- While the scenario states that access must be controlled and information kept confidential, it does not specify what each role can view or modify. The boundaries between roles are not defined.

### ● **Ambiguity:**

- Interpretation A: Access is broadly permissive – most users can view most application content, with only a few restricted fields.
- Interpretation B: Access is strictly role-based – researchers can only see their own applications, reviewers only see applications assigned to them, and sensitive information (e.g., conflict of interest declarations) is hidden from unauthorised users.

### ● **Expected Impact:**

- Directly informs Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) requirements.
- Determines the complexity of the permission model and what data must be restricted per role.
- Affects audit trail requirements – e.g., whether access events must be logged in addition to modifications.

## **1.7 How do you currently manage different versions of documents, and what problems does this cause?**

### ● **Uncertainty:**

- The scenario states that supporting documents should support versioning, but does not clarify what the current process looks like or how committee members are expected to compare revised documents during review.

### ● **Ambiguity:**

- Interpretation A: It is sufficient for the system to store and list document versions (e.g., Version 1, Version 2) as separate downloadable files, with no built-in comparison tool.
- Interpretation B: The system should include a document comparison (diff) feature that highlights exactly what changed between versions, so reviewers do not need to read both documents in full.

### ● **Expected Impact:**

- Interpretation B requires a significantly more complex and potentially costly document comparison module.
- The answer will determine the scope of the document versioning feature.
- Informs requirements around document storage, retrieval, and display within the system.

## **1.8 When an approved application needs modification or an extension, how is this currently handled? What would make that process easier?**

### ● **Uncertainty:**

- The scenario mentions that amendments or extensions may be required, but does not describe the process for handling them or whether they follow a different workflow from new submissions.
- **Ambiguity:**
  - Interpretation A: An amendment is treated as a completely new application and goes through the full submission and review process from the beginning.
  - Interpretation B: An amendment is handled as a linked update to the original approved application, with a lighter-weight review process focused only on what has changed.
- **Expected Impact:**
  - Determines whether the system needs to support a separate, simplified amendment workflow.
  - Affects how applications are linked and how version history is maintained across the application lifecycle.
  - Informs requirements for amendment submission forms, review routing, and audit trail continuity.